Walong Sector, attacked again. To meet this developing threat, nineteen-year-old Sepoy Kewal Singh burst out of the defences and, like a man possessed, took on the Chinese in hand-to-hand combat, fighting until he was gunned down. This attack too was beaten back and the Chinese once again withdrew into the lee of Ashi Hill to regroup and reorganize.

Later in the morning, Harbaksh and Hartley landed at Walong in a Mi-4 helicopter. The failed Chinese attack on Mithun had sent the battalion's morale sky high and the officers presented two Chinese automatic rifles that had been recovered earlier in the morning to the corps commander. Meanwhile, the advance party of 3/3 GR (affectionately known as Thud Thud) along with its commanding officer, Lieutenant Colonel Yadav, had arrived in Walong after a gruelling march from Hayuliang; they immediately moved across the river to the eastern side to do their initial reconnaissance of the area.

Meanwhile, Madiah briefed the two senior officers, going over the events in Kibithu. After a quick look around, Harbaksh Singh said that in his opinion, 6 Kumaon, 4 Sikh and the two wings of Assam Rifles were adequate for the defence of Walong, which apparently could be transformed into an impenetrable 'defence box'. According to him, 2/8 GR was surplus, and he issued orders for 3/3 GR to return to Hayuliang immediately.

This decision of Harbaksh Singh is yet another one of those unexplained mysteries of the 1962 conflict. Perhaps the corps commander actually believed that Walong was not defendable. According to the Thorat Plan, the main Indian defences in the Lohit Frontier Division were to have been at Hayuliang. If indeed Harbaksh was looking at fighting the Chinese at Hayuliang, only then is it possible to understand why he not only ordered 3/3 GR to turn back but also gave orders to extricate the two companies of 2/8 GR that were even then engaged in fighting the Chinese at The Ladders with 4 Sikh.

The decision to raise 2 Mountain Division was taken on 24 October in Army HQ. The official history says Major General Mohinder Pathania, until then commanding 23 Infantry Division in Nagaland under XXXIII Corps, had been moved laterally to take over 2 Mountain Division, which was to be a part of IV Corps, on 25 October itself. He is said to have visited Walong the next day. This is most definitely an error, for Pathania along with the DMO, Brigadier Palit, was on Se-la and had only returned to Tezpur later in the day on 26 October. Had he been designated GOC 2